Ex. No.: 12

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Approval Process in Zoho Creator

1. Aim

To build two approval processes in the RentEase application, Repair_Cost_Approval for repairs that cost more than Rs 5,000 and Deposit_Refund_Approval for deposit refunds, so that the owner decides on these before they are carried out.

2. Introduction

2.1 Approvals in Zoho Creator

An approval process lets a record be checked by one or more people before it is accepted. It is defined by a form, a criteria that decides which records need approval, one or more levels of approvers and the actions that follow an approval or a rejection. When a record meets the criteria, it is submitted for approval, the approver is notified, and the record stays pending until the approver approves or rejects it. Every decision is recorded with the record.

2.2 Approvals in RentEase

In RentEase the manager runs the rentals, but the owner must approve the larger decisions. The owner approves repair costs above Rs 5,000 and the refund of a tenant's deposit when the tenant moves out. For the demonstration, the admin account acts as the owner and is the approver. The approvals work together with the repair blueprint, where a costly repair waits in the Pending Approval stage, and with the Calculate_Refund workflow, which prepares the refund amount of a move-out request.

3. Objectives of the Study

- To create an approval process with a criteria, levels and approvers.
- To make repair costs above Rs 5,000 need approval at two levels.
- To send a deposit refund of a move-out request for approval.
- To approve a record as an approver and check the result in Access mode.

4. Procedure

1. Open the RentEase application in Edit mode and click Workflow in the top bar, then open Approvals.
2. Create the approval process Repair_Cost_Approval on the form Repair_Approval.
3. Set the criteria so that the approval applies when Quoted_Amount is greater than 5000.
4. Add two levels of approval and select the approver of each level, who is the admin user acting as the owner.
5. Save the approval process.
6. Create the approval process Deposit_Refund_Approval on the form Move_Out_Request, select its approver and save it.
7. Open the application in Access mode and add a Repair_Approval record with a Quoted_Amount above 5000. Check that it is submitted for approval.
8. Open the Approvals section as the approver, review the record and approve it at each level.

9. Open the record again and check its approval status.
10. Take a screenshot of the settings and of each result.

5. Detailed Analysis of the Approvals

Table 1 lists the two approval processes of RentEase.

Approval process	Form	Applies when	Levels and approver	Purpose
Repair_Cost_Approval	Repair_Approval	Quoted_Amount > 5000	Two levels; the approver is the admin user acting as owner	Approve costly repairs
Deposit_Refund_Approval	Move_Out_Request	A move-out request with a deposit refund	The approver is the admin user acting as owner	Approve the deposit refund

Table 1: Approval processes in RentEase

Table 2 shows how a repair record moves through the two levels of Repair_Cost_Approval.

Level	Approver	If approved	If rejected
Level 1	Admin user (owner)	The record goes to Level 2	The record is rejected and the process stops
Level 2	Admin user (owner)	The record is approved and the repair can be completed	The record is rejected and the process stops

Table 2: Levels of Repair_Cost_Approval

Table 3 explains the parts of an approval process and how each is used in RentEase.

Part	Meaning	Use in RentEase
Criteria	Decides which records are sent for approval	Quoted_Amount > 5000 for repairs
Level	A step in the approval chain	Two levels for repairs
Approver	The user who approves or rejects the record	Admin user acting as owner
Approval status	The state of the record in the process: Pending, Approved or Rejected	Shown on the Repair_Approval and Move_Out_Request records

Table 3: Parts of an approval process

A repair with a Quoted_Amount of Rs 5,000 or less does not meet the criteria, so it is not sent for approval and the manager can complete it directly. This is the same limit that the Maintenance_Lifecycle_Blueprint uses to choose between Complete and Send for Approval.

6. Output

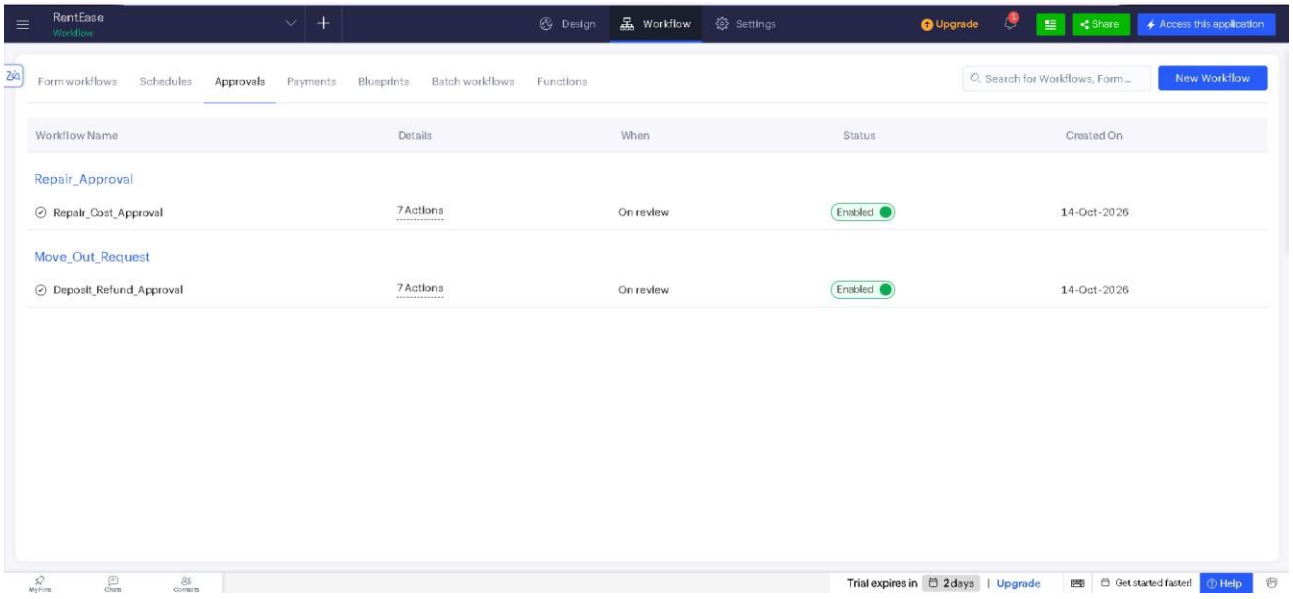


Figure 1: Approval processes of RentEase

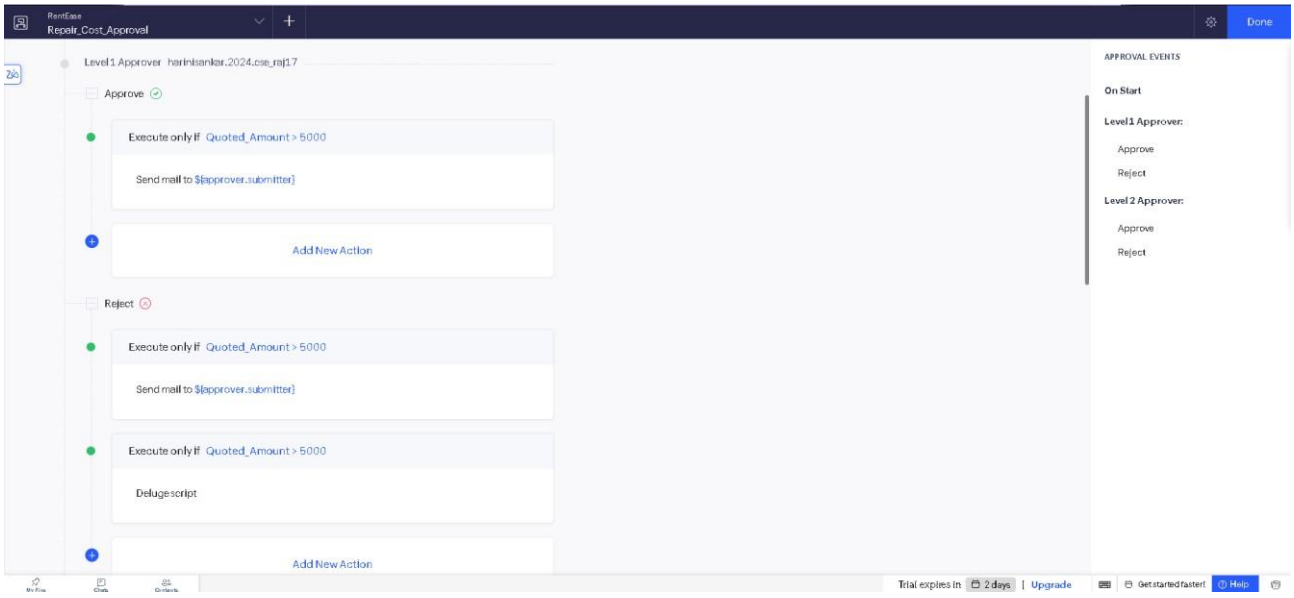


Figure 2: Levels and approver of Repair_Cost_Approval

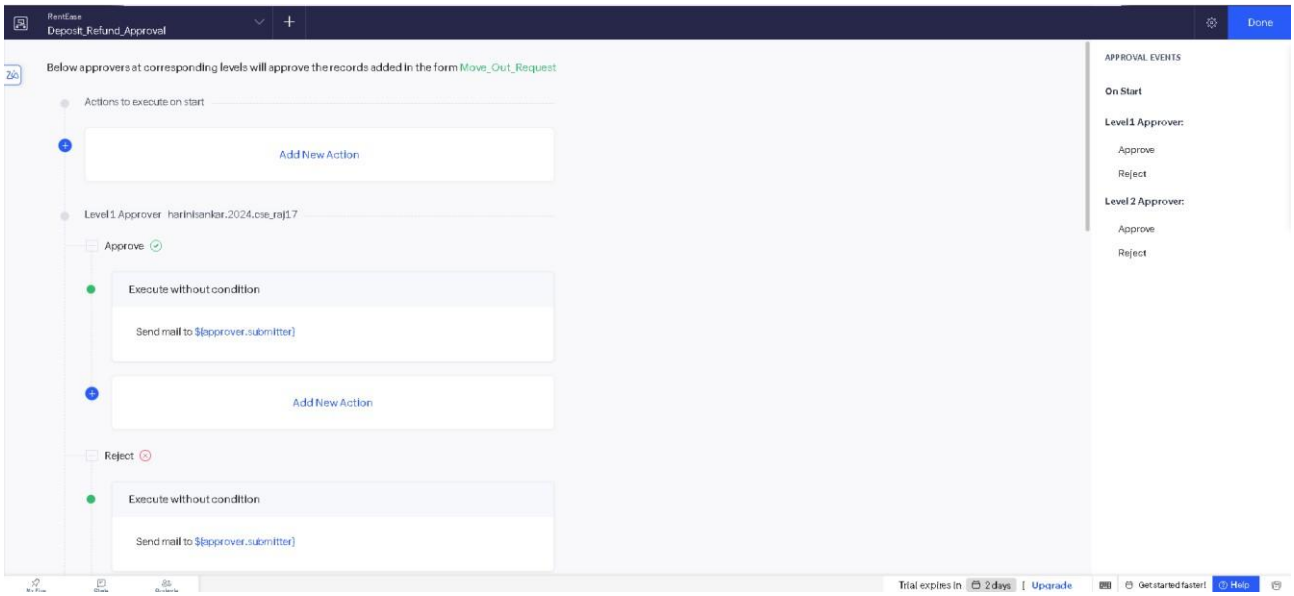


Figure 3: Deposit_Refund_Approval on the Move_Out_Request form

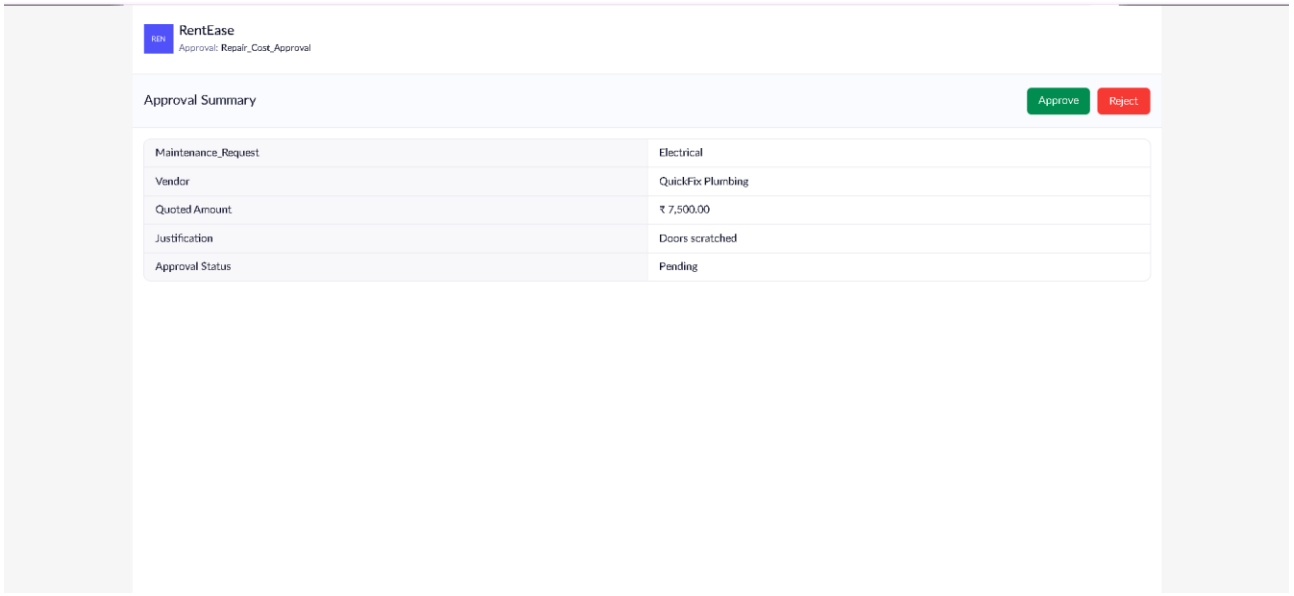


Figure 4: Approval Summary page with Approve and Reject buttons for a Rs 7,500 repair

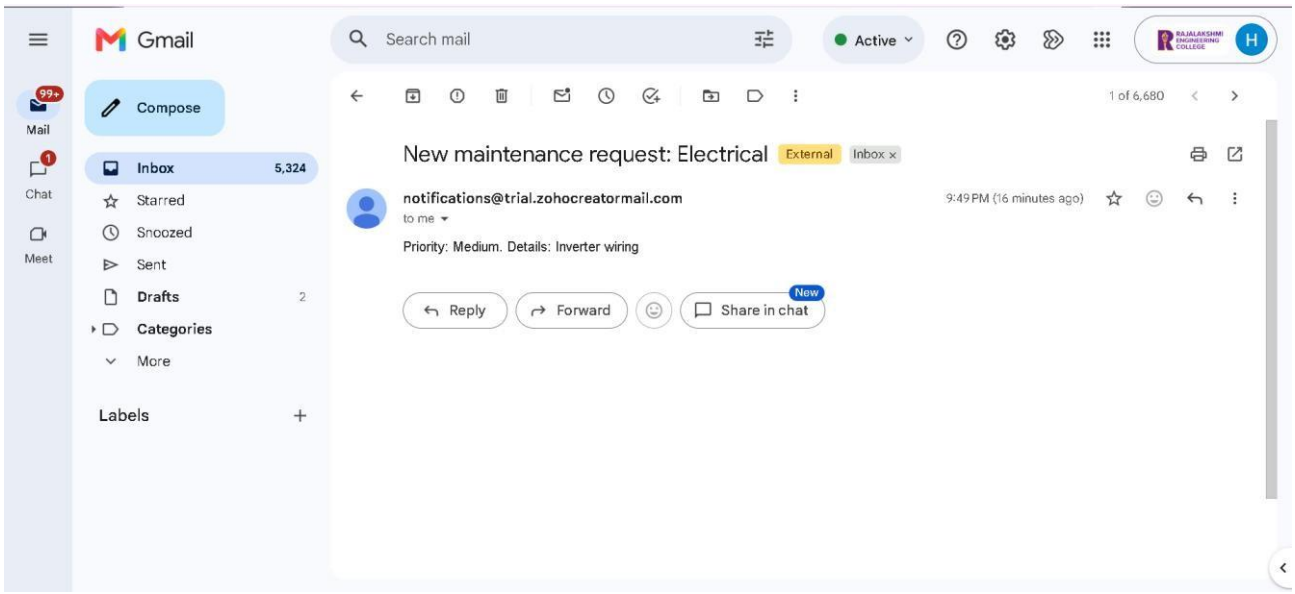


Figure 5: Email notification received when a new maintenance request is raised

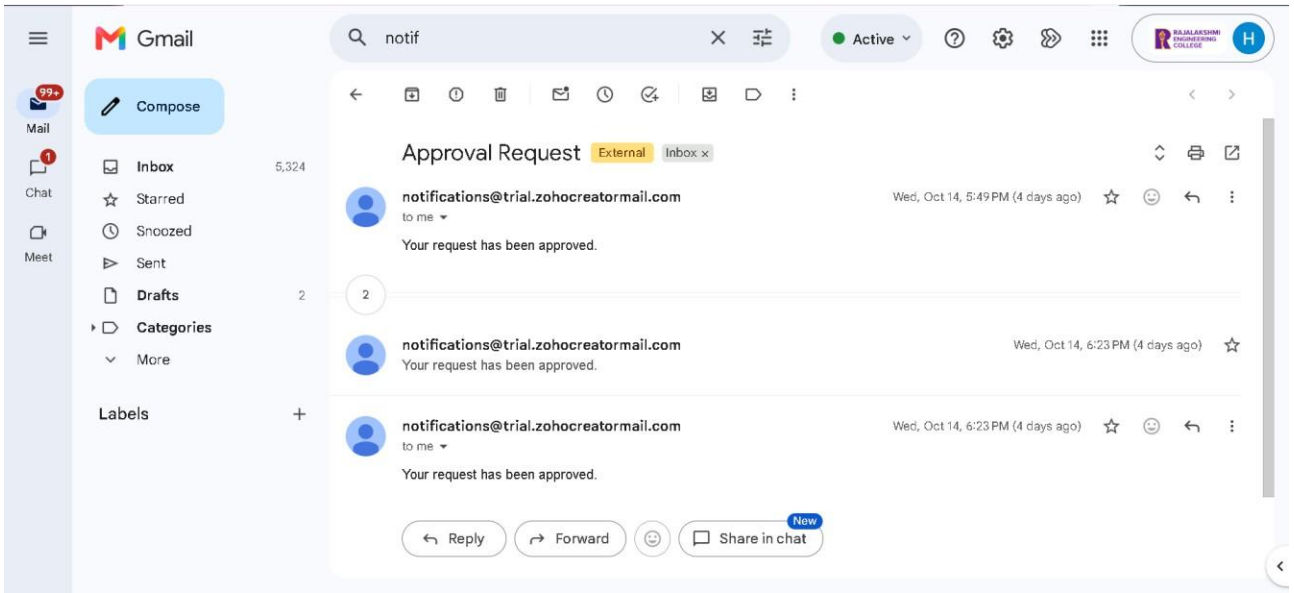


Figure 6: Approval Request emails confirming that the requests were approved

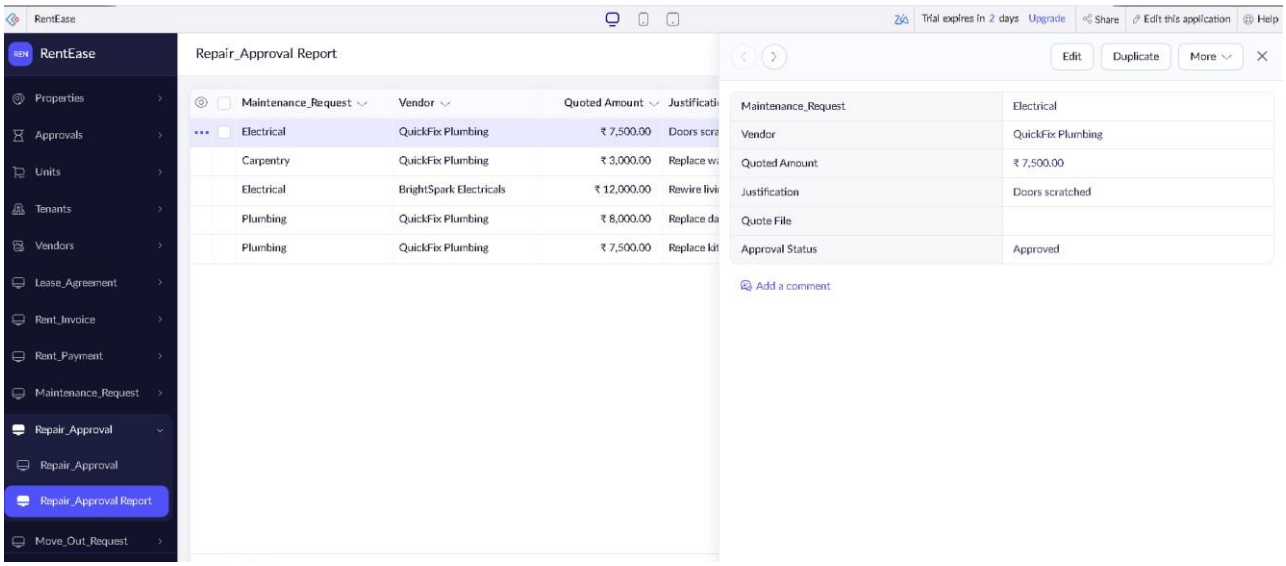


Figure 7: Repair_Approval record with Approval Status changed to Approved

7. Result

The approval processes Repair_Cost_Approval and Deposit_Refund_Approval were created in RentEase and tested in Access mode. A repair with a Quoted_Amount above Rs 5,000 is sent for approval at two levels, and a deposit refund of a move-out request is sent to the approver, who is the admin user acting as the owner. Repairs and refunds that need the owner's decision are therefore checked before they are carried out.